

needs. If you are exploring something new, you might want to get a prototyping board which is basic and has good documentation. Good prototyping boards to start off with are the Arduino and raspberry Pi which can even be used by kids! You can find the previous issues of FastTrack to learn various hardware and software tools covered in this issue at <http://dgit.in/MakerTechFTResources>. The deal with prototyping boards is that they provide a clean canvas, so you can add any components and burn code into it right out of the box. Most of the prototyping boards have external pins which can be used for Input-Output operations. There are several brands which sell assembled kits. These can be purchased online and contain an assortment of components along with a guide to build common projects. Websites like element14, tindie, Adafruit and Seeedstudio provide ready to use starter kits for common prototyping boards. Arduino and Raspberry Pi have official kits which you can use to start off with these prototyping boards. Alternatively, you can buy the components separately at your local electronics store after going through a few guides for projects.

You can also visit the various makerspaces in your city and enroll for a programme to get access to the tools and components they have on offer. A makerspace is an area which is dedicated to hobbyists and makers and has tools and components which are generally financially and logistically inaccessible to the common folk. So, head over to the makerspace near to your location and see what you can build today! 